

NAME	LIVED	ORIGIN	EXPEDITIONS/DISCOVERIES
Christopher Columbus	1451–1506	Italy	Discovered the Americas, landing in the Bahamas (1492); discovered the mainland of South America (1498)
John Cabot	c. 1450–99	Italy	Discovered mainland North America (1497)
Pedro Alvarez Cabral	c. 1467–1520	Portugal	Discovered Brazil (1500)
Amerigo Vespucci	1454–1512	Italy	Explored the coastline of South America (1501)
Afonso de Albuquerque	1453–1515	Portugal	Reached India via Zanzibar (1503–04)
Vasco Núñez de Balboa	1475–1519	Spain	First European to navigate the South Sea (Pacific Ocean), from Panama (1513)
Juan Ponce de Leon	c. 1460–1521	Spain	Discovered Florida (1513)
Hernán Cortes	1485–1547	Spain	Led the conquest of the Aztec Empire in Mexico (1518–22)
Ferdinand Magellan	c. 1480–1521	Portugal	Explored the Philippines; partially circumnavigated the globe (1520–21)
Francisco Pizarro	1475–1541	Spain	Led the conquest of the Inca Empire in Peru (1530–33)
Jacques Cartier	1491–1557	France	Explored the Gulf of St. Lawrence and St. Lawrence River (1535–36)
Francisco Vázquez de Coronado	1510–54	Spain	Reached the Grand Canyon in 1540
García López de Cárdenas	Active 1540s	Spain	Voyaged to Russia via the North Cape (1553–56)
Martin Frobisher	c. 1535–94	England	Reached the Frobisher Strait (Canada) while searching for the Northwest Passage (1576)
Francis Drake	c. 1540–96	England	Circumnavigated the globe (1580)
John Davis	c. 1550–1605	England	Explored Greenland, discovered the Davis Strait (1585) while searching for the Northwest Passage
Willem Barents	1550–97	Netherlands	Searched for the Northeast Passage (1594–97)
Walter Raleigh	1552–1618	England	Undertook numerous voyages to America; attempted, unsuccessfully, to found a colony in Virginia (1584)
Cornelis de Houtman	1565–99	Netherlands	Led first Dutch expedition to the East Indies; sailed the south coast of Java (1598)
Samuel de Champlain	1567–1635	France	Explored the St. Lawrence River (1603); founded Quebec (1608)
Henry Hudson	c. 1565–1611	England	Discovered Hudson Bay (Canada) (1610)
William Baffin	1584–1622	England	Explored Baffin Bay, part of the Northwest Passage (1616)
Abel Tasman	1603–c.1659	Netherlands	Reached New Zealand and Tasmania (1642)
William Dampier	1651–1715	England	Crossed the Pacific Ocean (1683)
Vitus Bering	1681–1741	Denmark	Explored Siberia (1733–41)
James Bruce	1730–94	Britain	Explored the Blue Nile; claimed to have found the source of the Nile (1768–74)
James Cook	1728–79	Britain	Mapped the New Zealand and Australian coasts (1769); made first Australian landfall, at Botany Bay, New South Wales (1770)
Antoine Bruni d'Entrecasteaux	1739–93	France	Surveyed the South Pacific (1791–93)
Mungo Park	1771–1806	Britain	Explored the Niger River (1795–96)
George Bass	1771–1803	Britain	Explored the coastline of southeastern Australia (1795–98)
Friedrich Alexander von Humboldt	1769–1859	Germany	Explored modern Venezuela and the Orinoco River (1799–1800)

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Matthew Flinders	1774–1814	Britain	Circumnavigated Australia (1801–03)
Meriwether Lewis	1774–1809	US	Led the first transcontinental expedition across the US (1804–05)
William Clark	1770–1838	US	Co-leader of expedition with Lewis (above)
Fabian von Bellingshausen	1778–1852	Estonia	Early explorer of the Antarctic (1819–21)
Alexander Gordon Laing	1793–1826	Britain	First European to reach Timbuktu, in Mali (1826)
William Edward Parry	1790–1855	Britain	Made an early attempt to reach the North Pole overland (1827)
James Clark Ross	1800–62	US	Made an extensive exploration of the Antarctic, discovering the Ross Sea and Ross Ice Shelf (1841)
John Franklin	1786–1847	Britain	Searched for the Northwest Passage; never returned from his expedition (1847)
Richard Francis Burton	1821–90	Britain	Traveled in Arabia and reached Medina and Mecca (1853)
David Livingstone	1813–73	Britain	Discovered the Victoria Falls on the Zambezi River (1855)
Robert O'Hara Burke	1820–61	Ireland	Led an ill-fated expedition to explore the Australian interior (1860–61)
Henry Morton Stanley	1841–1904	Britain	Undertook voyages down the Congo (1874)
Fridtjof Nansen	1861–1930	Norway	Crossed Greenland (1888)
Sven Hedin	1865–1962	Sweden	Explored Central Asia and discovered lost cities in the Taklamakan desert (1893–97)
Salomon Andrée	1854–97	Sweden	Attempted to balloon over the Arctic; disappeared during the flight (1897)
Otto Nordenskjöld	1869–1928	Sweden	Spent the winter in Antarctica (1901–03)
Francis Younghusband	1863–1942	Britain	Led an expedition that reached Lhasa in Tibet (1903–04)
Aurel Stein	1862–1943	Hungary	Explored Central Asia and located an ancient complex at Dunhuang (1906–08)
Robert Peary	1856–1920	US	Claimed to have reached North Pole (1909)
Roald Amundsen	1872–1928	Norway	First man to reach the South Pole (1911)
Robert Falcon Scott	1868–1912	Britain	Lost out to Roald Amundsen in the race to reach the South Pole (1911–12)
Ernest Shackleton	1874–1922	Britain	Led an expedition to cross Antarctica, but became stranded for four months on Elephant Island (1914)
Richard Byrd	1888–1957	US	Completed the first overflight of the North Pole (1926)
Vivian Fuchs	1908–99	Britain	Completed the first land crossing of the Antarctic continent (1958)
Wilfred Thesiger	1910–2003	Britain	Intrepid traveler who twice crossed the Empty Quarter of Arabia
Jacques-Yves Cousteau	1910–97	France	Marine ecologist who dedicated his life to deep-water oceanic exploration
Thor Heyerdahl	1914–2002	Norway	Sought to prove theories of prehistoric migration by sea with long voyages using rafts built from natural materials
Edmund Hillary	1919–2008	New Zealand	Completed the first ascent of Mount Everest in the Himalayas (1953)
Yuri Gagarin	1934–68	USSR	Vostok 1 (April 12, 1961); first man in space, and first to orbit the Earth
Alan Shepard	1923–98	US	Freedom 7 (May 5, 1961); first American in space, and later fifth man to walk on Moon
Gherman Titov	1935–2000	USSR	Vostok 2 (August 6, 1961); youngest person in space at 25 years old, and second man to orbit the Earth
Valentina Tereshkova	b.1937	USSR	Vostok 6 (June 16, 1963); first woman in space
Alexei Leonov	b.1943	USSR	Voskhod 2 (March 18, 1965); first tethered spacewalk

